

Art & Design

Year 1

Cambridge Early Years
Student Manual



ABOUT THIS BOOK

The Making Studio



Art & Design · Year 1 · Student Book. First edition, 2026.

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Editorial and design: Prime Books studio, Lisbon. **Illustration:** Prime Books studio. **Safety note:** the activities in this book use blunt needles, safety scissors and washable paint, and are designed to be done with an adult nearby.

★ A note for the adult reading with me

This book is meant to be used, not kept clean. It will be drawn in, stuck into and painted on, and that is the point. Read the instructions aloud together, then stand back and leave the choices to the artist. There are no printed answers in this book: a child says what they think out loud first, then circles, ticks or colours their own choice.



A portfolio at the end of the year, holding a drawing, a weaving and a painting. Everything in this book is made to be kept.

What is inside?



Four rooms in one studio. Each room has its own colour, and you will work in all four this year.

Unit 1 • The Mark Room	08	3.3 Texture	50
1.1 Marks and lines	11	3.4 My sculpture	52
1.2 Drawing tools	16	Unit 4 • The Paint Room	57
1.3 Looking and drawing	19	4.1 Brushes and tools	60
1.4 My own project	22	4.2 Mixing colour	62
Unit 2 • The Thread Room	25	4.3 Small and big	66
2.1 Weaving	29	4.4 My painting	67
2.2 Stitch and lace	31	Our studio show	72
2.3 My textile	35	My portfolio	74
2.4 Colour and texture	37	Art all through the year	76
Unit 3 • The Clay Room	42	My word book	78
3.1 Solid forms	45	Where we found out	86
3.2 Materials	48		

This is your studio



Six pairs of painted hands, and not one of them minded getting messy. This is what a good art lesson looks like at the end.

A studio is a room where people make things. Painters have studios, and so do people who sew, build and draw. This book is a studio too, and it belongs to you. You do not need to be good at art to start: you only need to be **curious**. Every artist in the world began by making a mark and looking at what happened.

■ Four rooms, four ways to make

In the **Mark Room** you draw. In the **Thread Room** you weave and sew. In the **Clay Room** you build shapes you can hold. In the **Paint Room** you mix colours and paint big.

★ Did you know?

People have been making art for a very, very long time. In a cave called Chauvet in France, there are paintings of animals that are about **32,000 years old**. That is older than every city on Earth.

Signs to look for



The same friendly signs come back on every page. Once you know them, you will always know what to do next.

Open the door

A question to talk about before you begin.

Warm up your hands

A quick game to wake your hands up.

Look and learn

Something new, with a picture that shows you how.

Go a bit further

An extra idea, if you would like more.

Did you know?

A true and surprising fact.

Big challenge

A harder task. Take your time.

◆ Your turn

1 Your turn means it is time to make something. When you see a dashed box, that space is yours to draw in.

There are no right answers printed in this book. You say what you think out loud, then choose.



A paintbrush and a pencil: two friends who live in this book.

Before you start



Your studio kit. You will not need all of it at once. Each room tells you what to fetch.

■ Four studio habits

- 1 **Apron on.** Sleeves pushed up.
- 2 **Cover the table** with newspaper before wet work.
- 3 **Wash your brush** before you change colour, or every colour turns grey.
- 4 **Tidy together.** The studio is ready for the next person.

★ **WORDS FOR YOUR STUDIO KIT**



apron

keeps you clean



brush

for painting



water

washes the brush



paper

to work on

Point at the four words above. Say each one out loud, then find that thing in your classroom.



The art table set up and waiting: paints sorted into a tray, brushes standing up, water on the left and an apron on the chair.

1

The Mark Room

Drawing and mark making

1.1 Marks and lines

1.2 Drawing tools

1.3 Looking and drawing

1.4 My own project



GET STARTED • UNIT 1

Every drawing starts with one mark

■ Open the door

Hold your finger up in the air and draw a big circle with it. Now a zigzag. Now your name. Your hand already knows how to make marks. Drawing is just doing that where it leaves a trace.

🏠 In this room you will

- ✓ make many different kinds of marks
- ✓ try five drawing tools and hear what each one is called
- ✓ look carefully at a real object and draw what you see
- ✓ make a drawing project that is all your own



A **mark** is any trace you leave on purpose. A dot is a mark. So is a long swooping line.

GET STARTED • UNIT 1

Wake up your hands

warm up

Shake and stretch. Shake your hands fast for five seconds. Squeeze them into tight fists, then spread your fingers wide like a star. Do it three times. Now your hand is ready to draw.

Do you remember colouring or drawing at home? What did you use: a crayon, a pencil, or your finger in the sand?

◆ Your turn

- 1 Without lifting your crayon at all, fill the whole box below with one long wandering line. Let it cross over itself as much as it likes.

This is called a scribble drawing, and real artists do it to warm up too.

one long line, never lift the crayon

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1 • MARKS AND LINES

Six marks to know

Marks have names, just like animals do. When you know the name, you can ask for the mark you want.



Figure 1.1 Six marks and their names. Say each name aloud as you point at it.

● Look and learn

A **line** goes from one place to another. A **dot** stays where it is. A **zigzag** keeps changing its mind. A **wave** changes its mind slowly and gently. A **spiral** goes round and round, getting bigger. **Loops** go up and over, again and again.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Point at Figure 1.1 and name all six marks out loud. Then trace each one in the air with your finger before you pick up a crayon.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1 • MARKS AND LINES

Make all six yourself

One box for each mark. Do them in any order you like.

◆ Your turn

- 2** Fill every box. Then try each mark again **fast**, and once more very **slowly**.

Slow marks and fast marks look different. Try both!

line		dots		zigzag	
wave		spiral		loops	
invent a brand new mark of your own					

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1 • MARKS AND LINES

Press hard, press soft

The same crayon can make a pale whisper or a dark shout. It all depends on how hard your hand presses.



Figure 1.2 The same house drawn twice. On the left the hand pressed softly. On the right it pressed hard.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Fill the long box below. Start as softly as you can on the left, and press harder and harder as you move right.

Charcoal is burnt wood. It makes the darkest, softest mark of any tool in the studio.

soft → hard

★ Did you know?

The very first artists used a soft black stick called **charcoal**, made from burnt wood, and an earthy red-yellow colour called **ochre**, which comes from clay in the ground. Artists still use both of them today.



UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1 • MARKS AND LINES

Dark words and light words

Point at each picture, say its word out loud, then find that thing in the room.

★ WORDS FROM THIS ROOM

**dark**

press hard

**light**

press softly

**charcoal**

burnt wood

**crayon**

wax stick

◆ Your turn

- 1 Copy each word on the line beside its picture. Copy the word only.

**dark**

**light**

**charcoal**

**crayon**

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2 • DRAWING TOOLS

Five tools, five voices

Every drawing tool has its own voice. A pencil whispers. A crayon is thick and waxy. Charcoal is soft and smudgy. A felt-tip is bold and never fades. A cotton bud is for smudging and softening.



Figure 1.3 Five drawing tools laid side by side: a red crayon, a blue pencil, a stick of charcoal, a dark felt-tip and a cotton bud, with the mark each one makes running underneath it.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Fetch the tools you have. Draw the same simple shape, a circle, in each box, using a different tool each time.

pencil	crayon	charcoal	felt-tip

◆ Your turn

- 2 Look at your four circles. Which tool did you like best? Tell the person next to you **why**.

There is no best tool. There is only the one you wanted.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2 • DRAWING TOOLS

Copy the tool words

Say each word, then copy just the word on the line beside its picture.



pencil _____



crayon _____



charcoal _____



felt-tip _____

→ **Go a bit further**

Try drawing with something that is not a drawing tool: a twig, a cotton bud or the corner of a folded card.

★ **Big challenge**

Draw a secret pattern below using three different tools. Then ask a friend to point at the crayon marks. Were they right?

my secret pattern

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2 • DRAWING TOOLS

More studio words

Six words for the marks you now know how to make.

**line**

goes somewhere

**dot**

stays still

**spiral**

round and round

**zigzag**

sharp corners

**wave**

soft and curvy

**loop**

up and over

Cover the words with your hand and look only at the pictures. Can you still name all six?



Soft on the left, hard on the right. Your hand decides.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3 • LOOKING AND DRAWING

Looking is the hard part

When you draw something real, your eyes do most of the work. Look at the object, then at your paper, then back at the object. Keep swapping. That is called **observational drawing**: drawing what you can really see.



Figure 1.4 Look, draw a little, look again. Never try to draw the whole thing from memory.

warm up

Five-second looking. Stare at your own hand for five whole seconds without drawing. Notice one thing you had never noticed before. Say it out loud.

Do you remember the six marks from earlier in this room? You will need them again now, to draw the lines you see inside a real leaf.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3 • LOOKING AND DRAWING

Draw from nature

Here are four things from outside. Choose **one**, look at it for a long time, then draw it in the big box.



leaf



shell



pine cone



feather

◆ Your turn

- 1 Draw your chosen object **big**, so it fills the whole box.

Big drawings are easier than small ones. Fill the space!

my drawing from looking

◆ Your turn

- 2 Circle the mark you used most in your drawing: line, dots, zigzag or spiral.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3 • LOOKING AND DRAWING

The oldest drawings of all

Long before anyone had paper, people drew on the walls of caves. They pressed their hands against the rock and blew colour around them, leaving a hand shape behind. You can still see those hands today.



Figure 1.5 Hand shapes on the wall of Cueva de las Manos in Argentina, whose name means **Cave of the Hands**. The oldest paintings there were made about 9,300 years ago. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.

★ Did you know?

Cave artists did not have brushes. They chewed colour and water together and sprayed it from their mouths around their hand, like a very old spray can.



You can try it safely with a pencil: put your hand flat on paper and draw all the way round it.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4 • STUDIO SHOW

1.4 • STUDIO SHOW

My Mark Museum

Make one big sheet that shows off every mark you can make. It is a museum, and you are the artist.



Figure 1.6 One finished Mark Museum. Four squares, four different marks, four colours. Yours will look nothing like this one, and that is right.

- 1 Fold** a big sheet of paper in half, then in half again. Open it out. You now have four squares.
- 2 Choose** four different marks from this room. One mark for each square.
- 3 Fill** each square completely with its mark. Use a different tool or colour in each one.
- 4 Show** your museum to a friend. Ask them to name the four marks. Then swap and name theirs.

UNIT 1 • HOW DID IT GO?

Think about your work

Colour **one** circle in each row. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, and red means not yet. Not yet is a fine answer: it just means you have more to do.

I can make six different marks.	☐ ☐ ☐
I know the names of four drawing tools.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can press hard and press softly on purpose.	☐ ☐ ☐
I looked carefully before I drew.	☐ ☐ ☐
I filled the whole space in my drawing.	☐ ☐ ☐

☒ Now I can

- ☐ make six different marks and name them
- ☐ name a pencil, a crayon, charcoal and a felt-tip
- ☐ draw a real object by looking at it



Which page in this room did you enjoy most? Turn back to it and show someone why.

UNIT 1 • STUDIO WORDS

The Mark Room words

Every word here has its own picture. Point, say, then find it in the room.



line

goes somewhere



dot

stays still



zigzag

sharp corners



spiral

round and round



loop

up and over



crayon

wax stick



pencil

thin grey stick



charcoal

burnt wood



felt-tip

bright ink



dark

pressed hard



light

pressed softly



paper

you work on it



leaf



shell

Every mark in this room came from a hand like yours.

2

The Thread Room

Weaving and sewing

2.1 Weaving

2.2 Stitch and lace

2.3 My textile

2.4 Colour and texture



GET STARTED • UNIT 2

Cloth is made of lines

Open the door

Look very closely at your sleeve. Can you see tiny lines crossing over each other? All cloth is made from threads that cross. Someone, or some machine, put every single one of them there.

In this room you will

- ✓ weave a thread over and under to make cloth
- ✓ sew a running stitch and lace round a card
- ✓ design a textile artwork of your own
- ✓ print and decorate fabric with colour and texture



Wool comes in many colours. Choosing which ones sit next to each other is already a design decision.

GET STARTED • UNIT 2

Weaving with no loom at all

warm up

Finger weaving. Hold your left hand up with your fingers spread wide. Those are the threads that wait. Now weave your right first finger over, under, over, under between them.

Do you remember pressing hard and softly in the Mark Room? In this room your hands learn a new job: pulling gently so the thread does not snap.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Draw four straight lines down the box below. Then draw one wiggly line that crosses them, going over one and under the next.

Lift your pencil where the line goes under.

over, under, over, under

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1 • WEAVING

Over, under, over, under

Weaving needs two sets of threads. One set waits, stretched tight. The other set travels across, going over one thread and under the next.

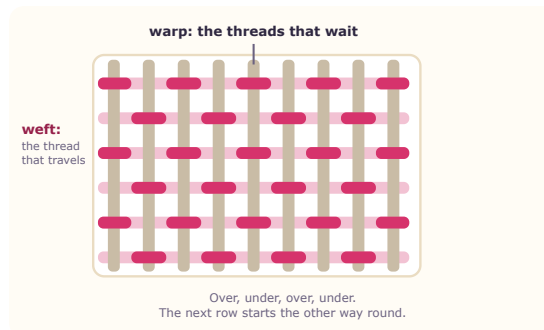


Figure 2.1 Plain weave. Follow the rose thread with your finger: over, under, over, under. The next row starts the other way round.

● Look and learn

The threads that wait are called the **warp**. The thread that travels is called the **weft**. Weft goes left to right, like reading. If you say "**warp waits, weft travels**" a few times, you will not forget.



Figure 2.2 A loom you can make from card.



Figure 2.3 A real wooden loom, about 200 years old. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1 • WEAVING

Weave your first row



Figure 2.4 Hold the loom steady with one hand. Guide the wool with the other. Pull gently, never hard.

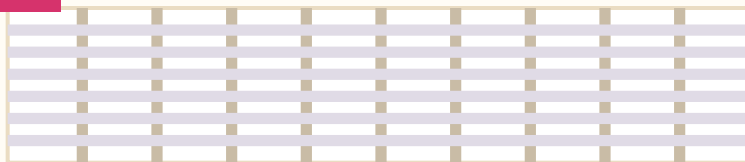
◆ Your turn

1 Take a card loom. Say "over" and "under" out loud as you do each one. Weave four rows.

2 Colour in the weaving below so it shows over and under. Colour the squares where the rose thread would be **on top**.

Look back at Figure 2.1 if you need to check.

colour the over squares



Go a bit further

Change to a new colour halfway up your weaving. Now you have made a **stripe**, and stripes are a pattern.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2 · STITCH AND LACE

Sewing is dotted lines

A stitch is a mark made with thread instead of a pencil. The simplest one of all is called **running stitch**, because the thread runs in and out of the cloth.

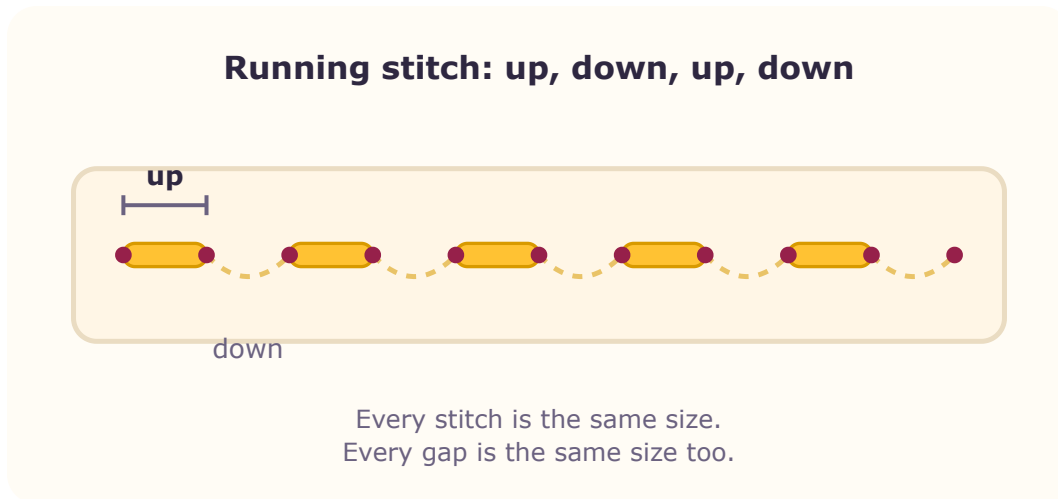


Figure 2.5 Running stitch. The thread shows on top for a stitch and hides underneath for a gap.



Figure 2.6 Push the blunt needle up through the hole, then down through the next one.

 Three rules for sewing

- 1** Keep every stitch the **same size**.
- 2** Keep every gap the **same size** too.
- 3** Pull the thread until it is **flat**, not tight and bunched.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2 • STITCH AND LACE

Lacing round the edge

Lacing is sewing round the outside of a shape. The holes are already punched for you, so all you do is follow the numbers.

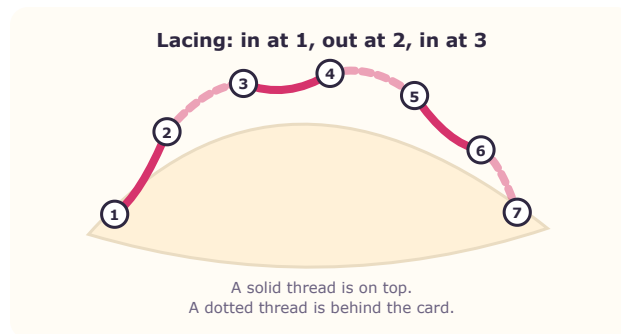


Figure 2.7 In at 1, out at 2, in at 3. Keep going all the way round.

✦ Your turn

- 1 Draw a row of running stitch along the dotted line below, the way a needle and thread would go. Count your stitches out loud.
If you have a needle and thread, try it on cloth or a punched card!

my running stitch

➔ Go a bit further

Sew a second row underneath the first, but start your stitches halfway along, so the two rows do not line up. Two rows that do not match make a pattern of their own.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2 · STITCH AND LACE

Lace a shape of your own

◆ Your turn

- 1 Lace all the way round a card shape. Choose your own wool colour, and follow the holes in order without skipping any.



Figure 2.8 A laced fish. The wool makes a border that holds the shape together.

★ WORDS FROM THIS ROOM



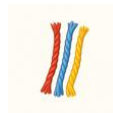
needle

blunt and safe



stitch

one in and out



thread

goes in the needle



felt

soft cloth

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3 • MY TEXTILE

Rugs made by hand for 500 years

In a small Portuguese town called **Arraiolos**, people have been sewing wool pictures onto cloth since at least the **1500s**. The rugs are so well known that the stitch they use is named after the town.



Figure 2.9 An Arraiolos rug from the 1700s, sewn with wool onto cloth. Look at the border: the pattern repeats all the way round. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons, public domain.

● Look and learn

Look at the middle of the rug, then at the border. Which part has a repeating pattern? Point to it and say what shape repeats.

★ Did you know?

The whole rug in Figure 2.9 is made of tiny **stitches**, thousands and thousands of them, all sewn by hand. Nobody could do it in a day. Some rugs took a whole year.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4 • COLOUR AND TEXTURE

How does it feel?

Texture is how something feels when you touch it. Cloth can be smooth, rough, fluffy or bumpy, and your fingers know the difference straight away.



Figure 2.10 Four fabrics. Close your eyes and feel each one before you look.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Find something smooth and something rough in your classroom. Sort them into the two trays below by drawing them.

smooth

rough

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4 • COLOUR AND TEXTURE

Printing a pattern

◆ Your turn

- 2 Print a pattern on cloth with a cut potato. Press, lift, move along, press again. Keep the gaps even, just like your stitches.



Figure 2.11 A potato stamp makes the same shape again and again. That is how a printed pattern is made.

★ Big challenge

Print two shapes, not one, and take turns between them: star, circle, star, circle. A pattern that takes turns is called a **repeat**.

★ WORDS FROM THIS ROOM



smooth

flat to touch



rough

bumpy to touch



pattern

it repeats



fringe

loose ends

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3 • STUDIO SHOW

2.3 • STUDIO SHOW

My Wall Hanging

Make one woven hanging that you would be happy to see on the wall at home.



Figure 2.12 A finished hanging on a wooden stick, with a fringe at the bottom. Yours will use your own colours.

- 1 Choose** three colours of wool that you like together. Hold them side by side before you decide.
- 2 Weave** in stripes, changing colour when you want to. Over and under every time.
- 3 Add** one thing that is not wool: a bead, a ribbon, a strip of cloth.
- 4 Tie** the top to a stick and trim the fringe. Now it is ready to hang.

UNIT 2 • HOW DID IT GO?

Think about your work

Colour **one** circle in each row. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, and red means not yet.

I can weave over and under without stopping.	☐ ☐ ☐
I know what warp and weft mean.	☐ ☐ ☐
My stitches are all about the same size.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can lace all the way round a shape.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can feel the difference between smooth and rough.	☐ ☐ ☐

☒ Now I can

- ☐ weave a plain weave on a card loom
- ☐ sew a running stitch with even gaps
- ☐ lace round the edge of a shape
- ☐ print a repeating pattern on cloth



Three finished textile artworks. Every one was made from thread and patience.

UNIT 2 • STUDIO WORDS

The Thread Room words

Every word here has its own picture. Point, say, then find it in the room.



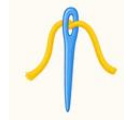
wool

soft and thick



thread

thin and long



needle

blunt and safe



loom

holds the warp



weave

over and under



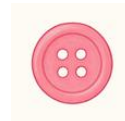
stitch

one in and out



felt

soft cloth



button

it fastens



smooth

flat to touch



rough

bumpy to touch



pattern

it repeats



fringe

loose ends



wool



loom

3

The Clay Room

Making shapes you can hold

3.1 Solid forms

3.2 Materials

3.3 Texture

3.4 My sculpture



GET STARTED • UNIT 3

Art you can walk around

■ Open the door

A drawing has a front and that is all. A **sculpture** has a front, a back, two sides, a top and a bottom. You can walk all the way round it. Think of a statue you have seen. Could you see the back of its head?

🏠 In this room you will

- ✓ name four solid forms and hold each one
- ✓ build with clay, card and other materials
- ✓ press textures into clay and make it stand up
- ✓ model a small sculpture that is all your own



Forms are solid. You can pick each one of these up, turn it round and look at its back.

GET STARTED • UNIT 3

What will clay do?

warm up

Squeeze and roll. Squeeze a lump of clay ten times. Roll it into a ball. Squash it flat. Roll it into a sausage. Your hands are finding out what clay will do before you ask it to do anything.

Do you remember drawing a shell in the Mark Room? A shell is a sculpture the sea made. Turn it over: it has a back too.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Make a ball of clay, then squash it. Draw the ball on the left and the squashed shape on the right.

Same clay, different form.

ball

squashed



Clay is soft earth from the ground. When it dries it goes hard and keeps every mark you made in it.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1 • SOLID FORMS

Flat shape, solid form

A circle you draw is **flat**. A ball you hold is **solid**. They look related, but only one of them has a back. A solid one is called a **form**.

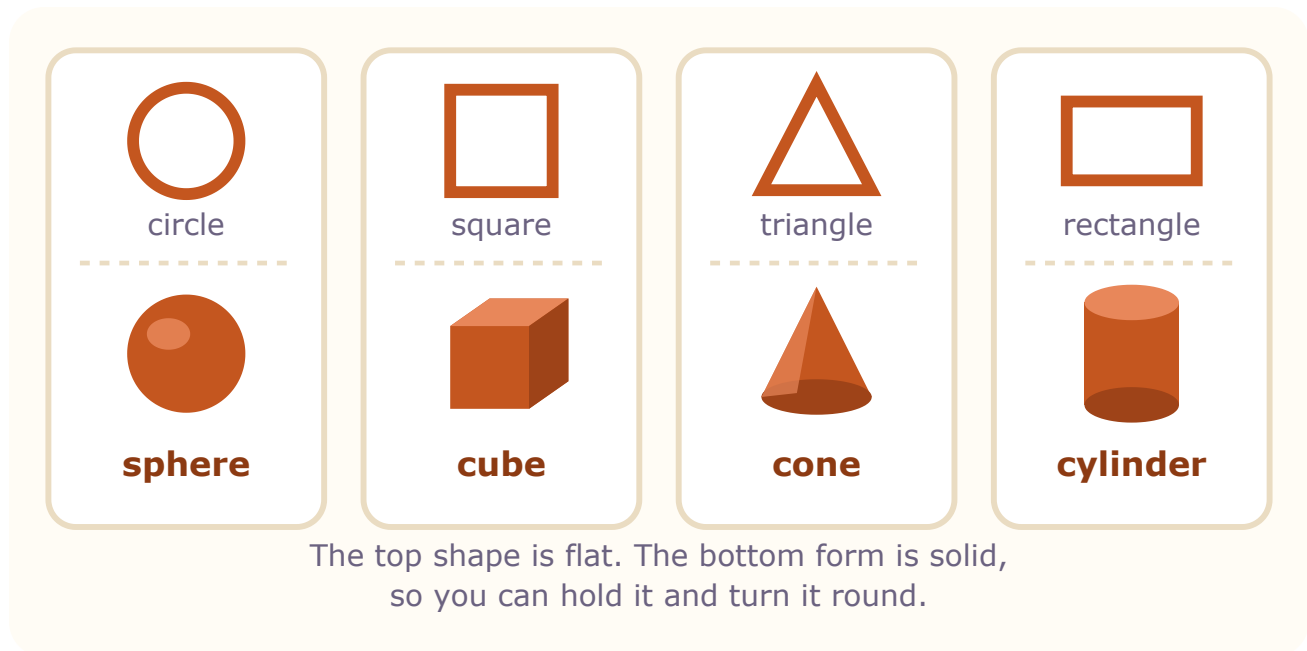


Figure 3.1 Four flat shapes on the top row, and the solid form that matches each one underneath.

● Look and learn

Say them out loud: **sphere** like a ball, **cube** like a dice, **cone** like a party hat, **cylinder** like a tin of beans. Four words, four things you can find in your kitchen.

◆ Your turn

1 Roll each form out of clay. Hold it up and name it.

2 Circle the form that is most like a party hat.



sphere



cube



cone



cylinder

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1 • SOLID FORMS

Two ways to make a pot

There is more than one way to build the same thing. Here are two ways to make a small pot, and both are thousands of years old.



Figure 3.2 A pinch pot. Push your thumb into a ball of clay, then pinch the walls thinner as you turn it.



Figure 3.3 A coil pot. Roll long sausages of clay and stack them in a circle, one on top of the next.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Make one pinch pot. Turn it slowly as you pinch, so the walls stay even.

- 2 Draw your pot in the box. Draw it from the **side**, so we can see how tall it is.

Then turn it round and draw the back too, if you like.

my pot from the side

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2 • MATERIALS

Not everything is clay

A sculpture can be made of almost anything. What matters is whether the material will do what you need: bend, stand, stick or hold.



Figure 3.4 Four sculpture materials: clay, card, pipe cleaners and crumpled newspaper with tape.

● Choosing your material

- **Clay** holds every mark, but it is heavy and can crack.
- **Card** is light and stands up well, but it will not bend smoothly.
- **Pipe cleaners** bend anywhere, but they cannot hold a big weight.
- **Newspaper and tape** make big shapes fast, and cost nothing.

◆ Your turn

- 1 You want to make a tall thin tree that bends in the wind.
Circle the material you would choose, then tell someone **why**.



clay



card



coils



rolling

★ Did you know?

Clay baked hard in a hot oven is called **terracotta: baked earth**.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3 • TEXTURE

Marks you press in

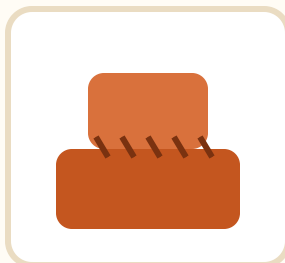
In the Mark Room you made marks **on** paper. In the Clay Room you press marks **into** clay. A fork, a bottle top, a leaf or a stick each leave their own.



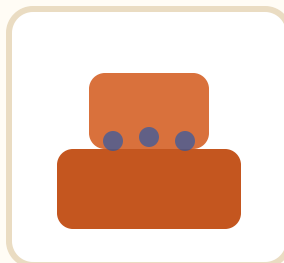
Figure 3.5 One clay tile, four textures, and the tool that made each one lying beside it.

Making two pieces stay together

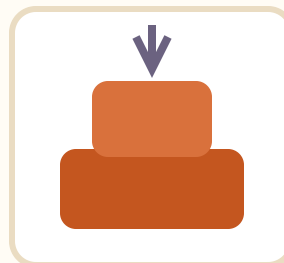
If you just rest one lump of clay on another, it will fall off when it dries. There are four steps that make a join hold, and you need all four.



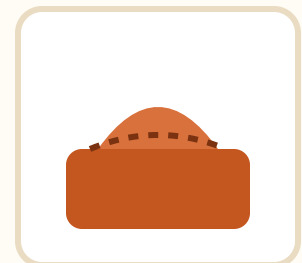
1. scratch



2. wet



3. press



4. smooth

Do all four steps and your clay pieces stay together when they dry.

Figure 3.6 Scratch, wet, press, smooth. Miss one out and the join will crack.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3 • TEXTURE

Making it stand up

Clay is heavy. Thin legs snap and wobble. A sculpture needs a **strong base**, and that is called its **structure**.



Figure 3.7 Two clay figures. One has thin wobbly legs. The other has thick legs and a wide base.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Circle the figure in Figure 3.7 that will still be standing tomorrow.
- 2 Press four different textures into a flat piece of clay. Then draw the patterns you made in the boxes below.

1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

★ Big challenge

Build the **tallest** clay tower you can that still stands on its own. Then make it one piece taller. When it falls over, look at where it broke: that is the weakest part, and now you know.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4 • MY SCULPTURE

Two famous sculptures

Sculptures can sit still, or they can move. Here is one of each, and both are real places you could go and visit.



Figure 3.8 A giant **Barcelos cockerel** in the town of Barcelos, Portugal. The little painted clay cockerels sold all over Portugal are all copies of this shape. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.



Figure 3.9 A **mobile** by the artist Alexander Calder. It hangs from one point and turns gently in the moving air, so it never looks quite the same twice. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.

★ Did you know?

Calder made his very first moving sculptures out of **wire**. In 1926 he built a whole tiny circus from wire, cloth, string and cork, and performed with it himself.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4 • STUDIO SHOW

3.4 • STUDIO SHOW

My Clay Creature

Make one small creature that stands up on its own and has textures you pressed in yourself.



Figure 3.10 A clay bird with patterns pressed into its wings. Notice the wide, flat base: that is why it stands.

- 1 Squeeze** a ball of clay into a fat body. Keep the bottom flat and wide.
- 2 Pinch** out a head, a beak or a tail. Pull the clay rather than sticking new bits on where you can.
- 3 Join** anything extra properly: scratch, wet, press, smooth.
- 4 Press** textures in with a stick or a fork, then leave it somewhere safe to dry.

UNIT 3 • HOW DID IT GO?

Think about your work

Colour **one** circle in each row. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, and red means not yet.

I can name a sphere, a cube, a cone and a cylinder.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can make a pinch pot.	☐ ☐ ☐
I know the four steps for joining clay.	☐ ☐ ☐
My sculpture stands up on its own.	☐ ☐ ☐
I pressed my own textures into the clay.	☐ ☐ ☐

☒ Now I can

- ☐ tell a flat shape from a solid form
- ☐ build a pot by pinching and by coiling
- ☐ join two pieces of clay so they stay together
- ☐ make a sculpture with a strong base



A whole class of clay creatures together makes a garden.

UNIT 3 • STUDIO WORDS

The Clay Room words

Every word here has its own picture. Point, say, then find it in the room.

**clay**

soft earth

**sphere**

like a ball

**cube**

like a dice

**cone**

like a party hat

**cylinder**

like a tin

**pinch**

thumb and finger

**coil**

a clay sausage

**roll**

flatten it out

**texture**

how it feels

**join**

make it stay

**card**

stiff paper

**balance**

it hangs level

→ Go a bit further

Make a **mobile** like Calder's. Hang cut card shapes from a stick with thread until it balances level. Moving it a tiny bit changes everything, so be patient.



clay

.....



texture

.....

4

The Paint Room

Brushes, colours, big and small

4.1 Brushes and tools

4.2 Mixing colour

4.3 Small and big

4.4 My painting



GET STARTED • UNIT 4

Three colours are enough

■ Open the door

How many colours do you think a painter needs? Twenty? A hundred? The surprising answer is **three**. From red, yellow and blue you can mix almost every colour there is, and in this room you will prove it yourself.

🏠 In this room you will

- ✓ try five painting tools and the marks they make
- ✓ mix new colours from only red, yellow and blue
- ✓ paint something tiny, then paint something huge
- ✓ paint a picture that is all your own



Three colours, and the three new ones they make when you mix them.

GET STARTED • UNIT 4

Paint with your whole arm

warm up

Air painting. Hold a dry brush. Paint a big rainbow in the air using your whole arm, moving from your shoulder and not just your wrist. Big paintings are made with big movements.

Do you remember the marks you made in the Mark Room? A brush can make every one of them too, and it can make them fat or thin.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Paint one huge stroke across the box below, moving your whole arm. Do not stop halfway.

One breath, one stroke.

one big arm stroke

Wash your brush in the water pot before every new colour. If you forget, every colour slowly turns grey.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1 • BRUSHES AND TOOLS

Five tools for paint

A fat round brush covers a lot of paper quickly. A thin brush is for the small careful bits. A sponge dabs. A roller rolls. Each one has a job.

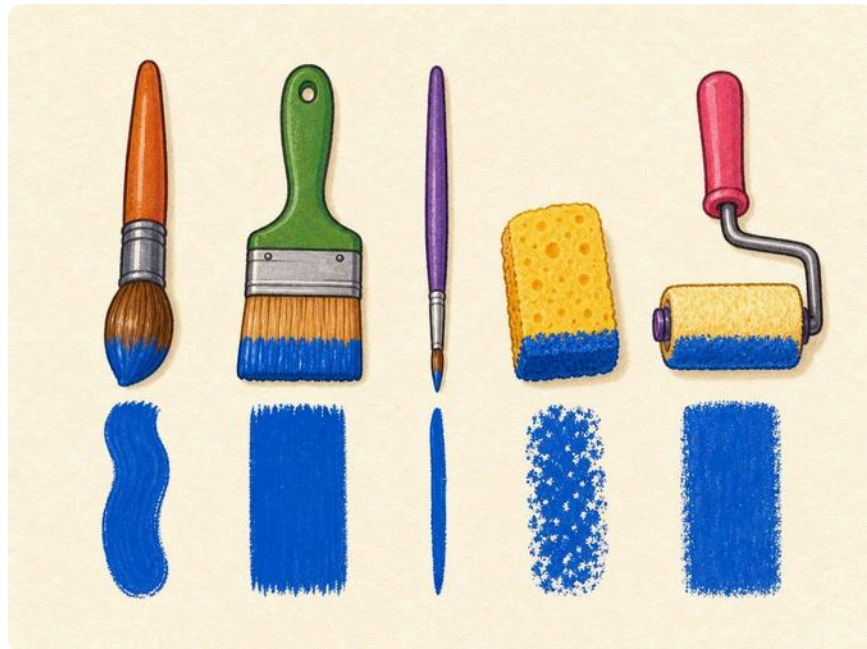


Figure 4.1 Five painting tools laid in a row: a fat round brush, a wide flat brush, a thin brush, a sponge and a roller, with the mark each one makes painted underneath it.

● Look and learn

Hold your brush like a pencil for careful work, near the metal part. Hold it further back, near the end of the handle, for big loose sweeps. Your hand position changes the mark before the paint even touches the paper.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Paint one stripe with each tool you have. Use the same colour every time, so the only thing that changes is the tool.

fat brush

thin brush

sponge

roller

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2 • MIXING COLOUR

The colour wheel

Red, yellow and blue are called the **primary colours**. You cannot mix them from anything else. But mix any two of them together and you get a brand new colour.



Figure 4.2 The colour wheel. The three big white circles are the primary colours. The colour between any two of them is what you get when you mix them.

● The three mixes to remember

- yellow + blue makes **green**
- yellow + red makes **orange**
- red + blue makes **violet**

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2 • MIXING COLOUR

Mix it yourself



Figure 4.3 Put the two colours side by side on the palette, then pull a little of each into the middle and swirl.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Mix the three new colours. Paint each one in its own box.

Start with the lighter colour and add the darker one slowly. It is much easier that way.

yellow + blue	yellow + red	red + blue

Four ways to move the brush



Figure 4.4 Dab, sweep, dry brush and wash. Same brush, same colour, four different results, with the name of each one printed under the mark it makes.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2 • MIXING COLOUR

Warm colours and cool colours

Some colours feel warm, like fire and sunshine. Others feel cool, like water and shade. Nothing is actually hot or cold, but your eyes think so anyway.



Figure 4.5 The same simple shapes painted twice: warm colours on the left, cool colours on the right.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Sort your paints into the two trays by painting a blob of each one in the right place.

warm

cool

★ WORDS FROM THIS PAGE

**warm**

like the sun

**cool**

like water

**mix**

two make one

**palette**

where you mix

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3 • SMALL AND BIG

Tiny paintings and huge ones

The size of a painting is called its **scale**. A tiny painting asks your fingers to do the work. A huge one asks your whole arm, and sometimes your legs too.



Figure 4.6 The same sunflower painted small with a thin brush, and huge with a fat brush.

◆ Your turn

- 1 Paint a flower as **small** as you can in the little box.

tiny

the same flower, bigger

◆ Your turn

- 2 Now paint the same flower on a **very big** sheet on the floor. Stand up and use your shoulder, not your wrist.

Which was more fun? There is no wrong answer.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4 • MY PAINTING

Painting on walls with tiles

In Portugal, whole walls are covered with painted tiles called **azulejos**. Most of the famous ones use only **one colour**, a deep blue, painted on white. One tile on its own is not much. Hundreds together tell a story.



Figure 4.7 An azulejo panel. Count the tiles: each square was painted on its own, then they were fitted together like a puzzle. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.

★ Did you know?

That famous blue comes from a metal called **cobalt**. It travelled all the way from China and Persia along trading routes before Portuguese tile painters began using it.

★ Big challenge

Paint a picture with **no brush at all**. Use a sponge, a folded card, your fingers or a leaf dipped in paint.



Make your own panel: everybody paints one square in blue, then you lay them all side by side.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4 • STUDIO SHOW

4.4 • STUDIO SHOW

Our Painted Garden

The whole class paints one enormous garden together, on one long roll of paper.



Figure 4.8 A class mural. Every flower was painted by a different pair of hands, and it still looks like one garden.

- 1 Agree** on the colours for the whole garden first, so it holds together. Mix them all before anyone starts.
- 2 Paint the biggest things first:** the ground, the sky, the big leaves. Use fat brushes and work standing up.
- 3 Wait** for it to dry. Then add the small things on top with thin brushes: petals, birds, butterflies, bugs.
- 4 Hang** it up along the corridor and walk the whole length of it slowly, finding everybody's part.

UNIT 4 • HOW DID IT GO?

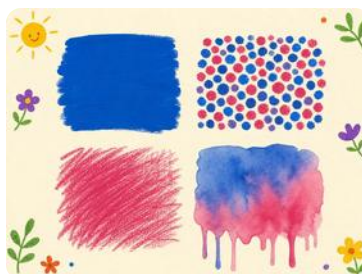
Think about your work

Colour **one** circle in each row. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, and red means not yet.

I can name the three primary colours.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can mix green, orange and violet.	☐ ☐ ☐
I choose the right brush for the job.	☐ ☐ ☐
I wash my brush before changing colour.	☐ ☐ ☐
I have painted something small and something big.	☐ ☐ ☐

☒ Now I can

- ☐ use a fat brush, a thin brush, a sponge and a roller
- ☐ mix new colours from red, yellow and blue
- ☐ tell warm colours from cool colours
- ☐ paint at a small scale and at a big scale



Flat colour, dabs, dry brush and a wet wash: four techniques you now know.

UNIT 4 • STUDIO WORDS

The Paint Room words

Every word here has its own picture. Point, say, then find it in the room.



brush
for painting



flat brush
wide and straight



paint
colour in a pot



palette
where you mix



mix
two make one



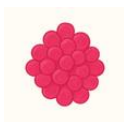
sponge
it dabs



roller
it rolls



wash
thin and watery



dab
press and lift



dry brush
hardly any paint



water
washes the brush



apron
keeps you clean

Copy the words



paint



brush



Our studio show

An artist finishes a piece of work, and then they **show** it. That is part of the job. At the end of the year your class puts everything on the wall and invites people in to look.

Four jobs to share out



Everybody in the class has a job on show day. Read the four jobs, then choose the one you would like to do.

- 1 The **hangers** decide where each artwork goes on the wall.
- 2 The **labellers** write a card for each piece: the artist's name and what it is made of.
- 3 The **guides** walk visitors round and explain the four rooms.
- 4 The **greeters** welcome people at the door.

✦ Your turn

- 1 Write or draw the job you would like on show day, and one reason why.

my job on show day

My portfolio



A **portfolio** is the folder where an artist keeps their work. Yours shows how much you have learnt this year, far better than any test could.



Keep your work flat in a folder. Write your name and the date on the back of every piece.

■ Four things to put in

- ☐ one drawing from the Mark Room
- ☐ one woven or sewn piece from the Thread Room
- ☐ one photograph of your Clay Room sculpture
- ☐ one painting from the Paint Room

◆ My best work

- 1 Choose the **one** piece you are proudest of. Draw a small copy of it in the frame, then tell someone why you chose it.

my best work this year

Art all through the year



Art is not only for art lessons. Here is what the studio makes for the school each term.



Four seasons, four ways of making. The same subject looks different in every room.

Term 1 **Autumn walk**

Collect leaves, seeds and cones, then draw them from looking. Mark Room.

Term 1 **Winter decorations**

Lace and sew shapes to hang in the window. Thread Room.

Term 2 **Clay creature garden**

Every child makes one creature for a shared display. Clay Room.

Term 3 **Corridor mural**

The whole class paints one long garden together. Paint Room.

Which activity are you looking forward to most?

The Mark Room (1)



Every word from this room, with its picture and what it means.



line

a mark that travels from one place to another



dot

a small round mark that stays still



zigzag

a line with sharp corners



spiral

a line that goes round and round



loop

a line that goes up and over, again and again



crayon

a thick wax stick for drawing

Copy two words



line



dot

The Mark Room (2)



pencil

a thin grey stick that whispers



charcoal

burnt wood that makes the darkest mark



felt-tip

bold ink that never fades



dark

what you get when you press hard



light

what you get when you press softly



paper

the flat sheet you work on

Copy two words



pencil



dark

The Thread Room (1)



wool

soft thick thread that comes from a sheep



thread

a long thin line you can sew with



needle

blunt and safe, it carries the thread



loom

the frame that holds the warp tight



weave

to go over one thread and under the next



stitch

one in and out of the cloth

Copy two words



wool



weave

The Thread Room (2)



felt

soft cloth that does not fray when you cut it



button

a small round fastener you can sew on



smooth

flat and even under your fingers



rough

bumpy and uneven under your fingers



pattern

something that happens again and again



fringe

the loose ends left hanging at the bottom

Copy two words



smooth



rough

The Clay Room (1)



clay

soft earth that goes hard when it dries



sphere

a solid form shaped like a ball



cube

a solid form shaped like a dice



cone

a solid form shaped like a party hat



cylinder

a solid form shaped like a tin of beans



pinch

to press clay between thumb and finger

Copy two words



clay



cube

The Clay Room (2)



coil

a long clay sausage you can stack



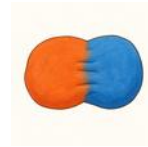
roll

to flatten clay out with a rolling pin



texture

how a surface feels when you touch it



join

scratch, wet, press and smooth, so it stays



card

stiff paper that stands up on its own



balance

when a hanging sculpture rests level

Copy two words



coil



join

The Paint Room (1)



brush

the tool you paint with



flat brush

a wide straight brush for big areas



paint

colour in a pot, ready to use



palette

the tray where you mix your colours



mix

to put two colours together to make one new one



sponge

it dabs paint on in a soft patch

Copy two words



paint



mix

The Paint Room (2)



roller

it rolls a wide band of colour



wash

paint mixed with lots of water, thin and see-through



dab

press the brush down and lift it straight up



dry brush

hardly any paint, so the mark looks scratchy



water

it washes the brush between colours



apron

it keeps your clothes clean

Copy two words



wash



water

Our sources



Every fact and every photograph of a real object in this book comes from somewhere real. Here is where, so an adult can look it up with you.

★ The facts we checked

- **Page 04, Chauvet Cave.** The painted animals in the Chauvet-Pont-d'Arc cave in the Ardeche, France, are dated to roughly 32,000 to 30,000 years ago. Chauvet Cave, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chauvet_Cave
- **Page 14, ochre.** Ochre is a family of natural clay earth pigments made of ferric oxide with clay and sand, ranging from yellow to deep orange or brown. Ochre, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026.
- **Page 21, Cueva de las Manos.** The hand stencils in Santa Cruz, Argentina, were made in several waves; the earliest rock art at the site dates to about 7,300 BC, roughly 9,300 years ago. Cueva de las Manos, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026. en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cueva_de_las_Manos
- **Page 35, Arraiolos.** Embroidered wool rugs have been made in Arraiolos, Portugal, since at least the 16th century, and by the late 17th century they appear in Lisbon customs records. Arraiolos, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026.
- **Page 52, Alexander Calder.** Calder built Cirque Calder, a miniature circus of wire, cloth, string and cork, from 1926 onwards, and performed with it himself. Alexander Calder, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026.
- **Page 67, azulejos.** The blue of Portuguese tin-glazed tiles comes from cobalt, a pigment that reached Europe along trading routes from China and Persia. Azulejo, Wikipedia, accessed 29 July 2026.

Photograph credits

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★ The photographs

- **Figure 1.5** Hand stencils, Cueva de las Manos, Santa Cruz, Argentina. Wikimedia Commons.
- **Figure 2.3** A wooden hand loom, about 200 years old. Wikimedia Commons.
- **Figure 2.9** An Arraiolos wool rug of the 1700s. Wikimedia Commons, public domain.
- **Figure 3.8** The giant cockerel of Barcelos, Portugal. Wikimedia Commons.
- **Figure 3.9** A mobile by Alexander Calder. Wikimedia Commons.
- **Figure 4.7** An azulejo tile panel, Portugal. Wikimedia Commons.
- **Closing page** A giant red heart by the Portuguese artist Joana Vasconcelos, its shape taken from the traditional filigree Heart of Viana. Wikimedia Commons.



Every fact in this book was looked up before it was printed.

Four rooms. One studio. Yours.

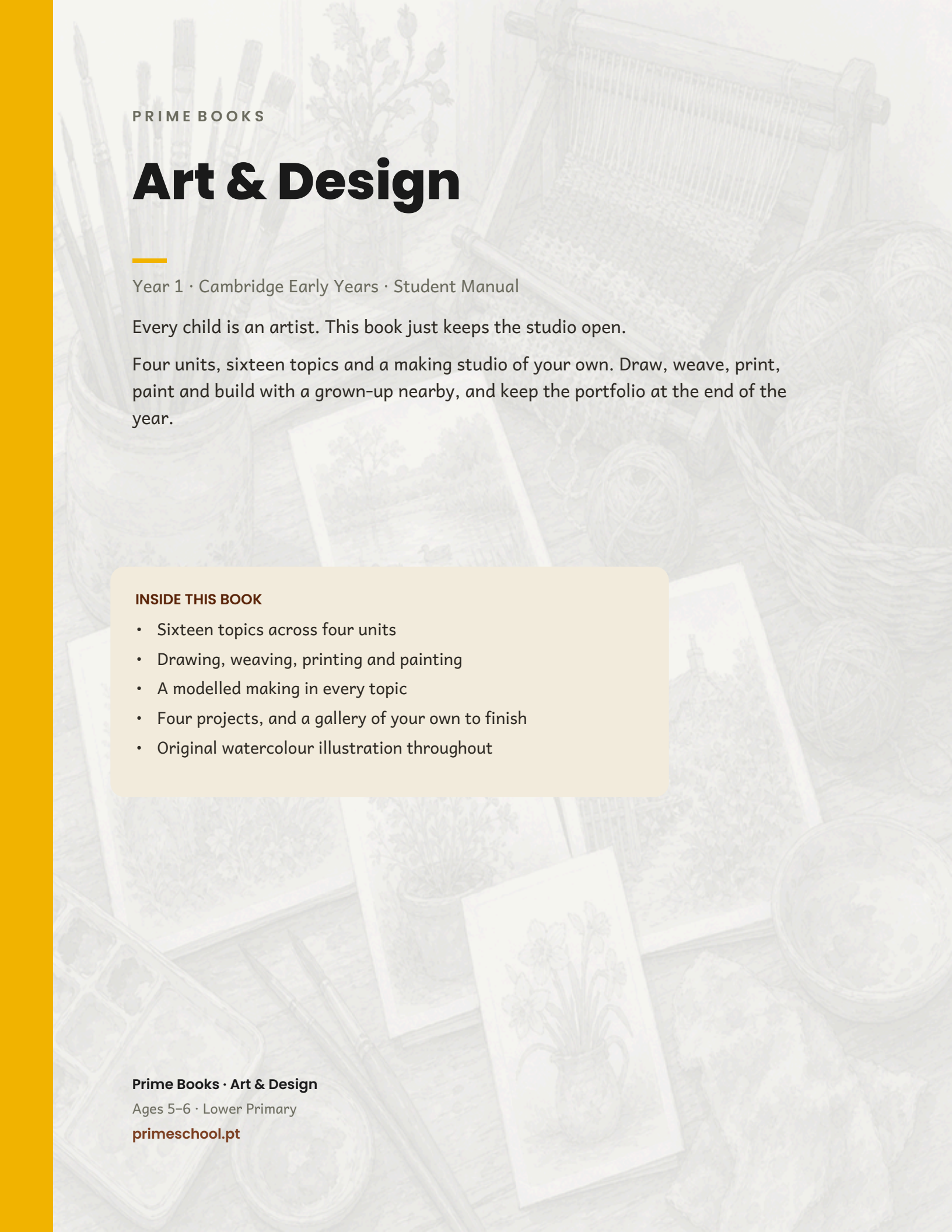


Open the door of **The Mark Room** and make every mark your hand can make. Cross the hall to **The Thread Room** and weave a thread over and under until it becomes cloth. In **The Clay Room** build something solid you can hold and turn round. Then push open **The Paint Room** and discover that three colours are enough to make them all.

Along the way you will meet cave artists who painted round their own hands, rug makers who sewed for a whole year, a sculptor whose art hangs in the air, and the deep blue tiles that cover the walls of Portugal.



One last artwork. A giant red heart by the Portuguese artist **Joana Vasconcelos**, its shape taken from the traditional filigree Heart of Viana. Photograph: Wikimedia Commons.



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